

MARMOSETS AND TAMARINS

The Callitrichidae consists of relatively small social monkeys, which inhabit a variety of forests throughout tropical and subtropical Central and South America. They are all diurnal and arboreal and have forward-facing eyes and a short muzzle. Marmosets and tamarins have a long, non-prehensile tail, lack the third molar, and have claws instead of nails.



19–25 cm
7½–10 in

GOELDI'S MONKEY

Callimico goeldii

Inhabiting dense forest undergrowth, such as that of bamboo forest in the upper Amazon, this monkey makes forays into the tree canopy for fruits.



20–23 cm
8–9 in

SILVERY MARMOSET

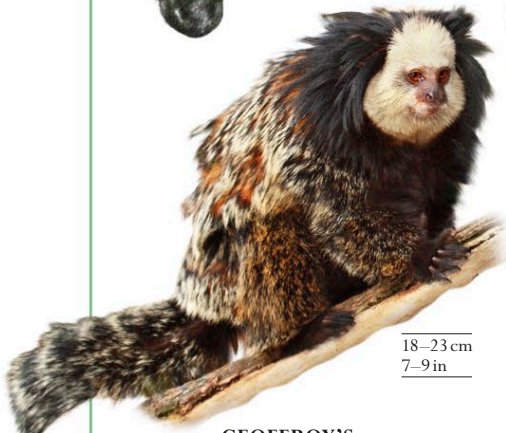
Mico argentatus

A specialized gum-eater (gumivore), this marmoset has huge ears, narrow jaws, and short canine teeth for cutting into tree bark.

COMMON MARMOSET

Callithrix jacchus

The female of this species generally mates with two males, both of whom assist with parental care of the usually twin offspring.



18–23 cm
7–9 in

GEOFFROY'S TUFTED-EAR MARMOSET

Callithrix geoffroyi

Also called the white-headed marmoset, this species uses scent-marks to deter others from using the holes it makes in tree bark to extract gum.



20–23 cm
8–9 in

BLACK-TUFTED-EAR MARMOSET

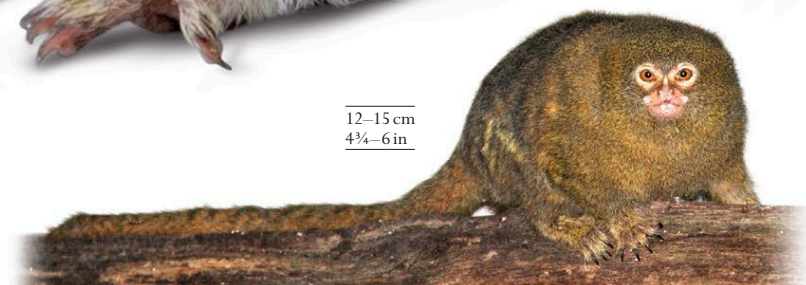
Callithrix penicillata

A monogamous species, this primate is diurnal and lives high in the rainforest canopy, where it feeds on tree sap.



long, curved claws

16–21 cm
6½–8½ in



12–15 cm
4¾–6 in

PYGMY MARMOSET

Cebuella pygmaea

The smallest monkey in the world, this species eats tree gum in seasonally flooded forests of the upper Amazon basin.



fine, yellow hair on back

23–26 cm
9–10 in

EMPEROR TAMARIN

Saguinus imperator

Distinguished by its long, white moustache, this tamarin lives in the tropical forests in Peru, Brazil, and Bolivia.



21–28 cm
8½–11 in

WHITE-LIPPED TAMARIN

Saguinus labiatus

The dominant female of this species releases chemical signals, called pheromones, that suppress reproduction in other female members of the group.



23–33 cm
9–13 in

BARE-FACED TAMARIN

Saguinus bicolor

Also called the pied tamarin, this tree-dwelling primate lives in lowland forest in the central Amazon region near Manaus, Brazil.